

SENATE No. 975

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Kelly A. Dooner

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing residency requirements for emergency housing assistance.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Kelly A. Dooner</i>	<i>Third Bristol and Plymouth</i>	
<i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>	<i>5th Barnstable</i>	<i>4/2/2025</i>

SENATE No. 975

By Ms. Dooner, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 975) of Kelly A. Dooner for legislation to establish residency requirements for emergency housing assistance. Housing.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing residency requirements for emergency housing assistance.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 30 of Chapter 23B of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official
2 Edition, is hereby amended by inserting the following paragraph after the first paragraph:-

3 (a) Notwithstanding any general or special law, rule, or regulation to the contrary,
4 eligibility for the emergency housing assistance program shall be limited to (1) United States
5 citizens and (2) lawfully present immigrants who have maintained continuous legal residency in
6 the Commonwealth of Massachusetts for at least 12 consecutive months immediately prior to the
7 date of application.

8 (b) Acceptable proof of legal residency must consist of the following two forms of
9 documentation, both issued at least 12 months before the application date:

10 Proof of U.S. Citizenship or Lawful Permanent Residency: (1) A valid U.S. Passport with
11 a Massachusetts address; (2) A certified U.S. Birth Certificate with proof of Massachusetts

residency; (3) A valid Certificate of Naturalization or Citizenship; (4) A valid Green Card (Permanent Resident Card) issued at least one year prior.

Proof of Continuous Residency in Massachusetts: (1) Filed Massachusetts state income tax return for the most recent tax year r; (2) Valid REAL ID-compliant Massachusetts driver's license issued at least one year prior; (3) Utility bill, lease, or mortgage statement in the applicant's name, dated at least one year prior; Or (4) pay stubs showing continuous Massachusetts employment for at least one year.

(d) All submitted documentation shall be subject to verification by the Executive Office of Housing and Livable Communities in coordination with the Department of Revenue and the Registry of Motor Vehicles. Any attempt to submit fraudulent documents will result in permanent disqualification from the program.

(f) The Executive Office of Housing and Livable Communities shall promulgate regulations to enforce this residency requirement, including procedures for cross-agency verification and fraud detection.